BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #16 · AGING AND DECLINE

"I'm old and useless."

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Where it often comes from

Retirement, slower pace, and a culture that prizes youth can make older adults feel invisible. Loss of work, driving, or strength adds to the sense of being no longer needed.

What Scripture teaches

"In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain" (Psalm 92:14). "Gray hair is a crown of glory; it is attained along the path of righteousness" (Proverbs 16:31). "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray." Anna served God day and night in the temple in her eighties (Luke 2:36–37). Paul told Titus that older men and women are to teach others (Titus 2). Older believers hold wisdom and prayer that the church needs.

> *"In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain"* (Psalm 92:14).

Also see

> "Gray hair is a crown of glory; it is attained along the path of righteousness" (Proverbs 16:31).

> "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you" (Isaiah 46:4).

> "Even when I am old and gray, do not forsake me, O God, until I proclaim Your power to the next generation, Your might to all who are to come" (Psalm 71:18).

> "Older men are to be temperate, dignified, self-controlled, and sound in faith, love, and perseverance. Older women, likewise, are to be reverent in their behavior, not slanderers or addicted to much wine, but teachers of good" (Titus 2:2–3).

Common self-statements

- Nobody needs me.
- I have nothing left to give.
- Young people do not care what I think.
- I am in the way.
- I am past my usefulness.
- My time is over.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either productive or useless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will need me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling overlooked and concluding that I am useless.
- Labeling: Calling myself useless.

Challenging questions

- What do I know and have lived through that others could learn from?
- Who has asked for my advice or prayers?
- What could I give: time, listening, prayer, a skill?

- What does Scripture say about the elderly?
- Who in my life is lonely and might welcome a call?
- What is one way to serve this week?

Truth summary

> God still uses me. My years are a crown, and my wisdom and prayers matter. I can bear fruit at every age, in ways large and small.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Elderly
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Fruitful
- Thankful
- Joy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Do It Again — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's repeated gifts and new mercies express His continuing love.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm old and useless"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm old and useless." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I know and have lived through that others could learn from?
- ☐ Who has asked for my advice or prayers?
- ☐ What could I give: time, listening, prayer, a skill?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the elderly?
- ☐ Who in my life is lonely and might welcome a call?
- ☐ What is one way to serve this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I still bear fruit in old age.
- ☐ Gray hair is a crown.
- ☐ God will carry me.
- ☐ My wisdom matters.
- ☐ I can pray for others.
- ☐ I am not useless.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 92:14**
  "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain."
- ☐ **Proverbs 16:31**
  "Gray hair is a crown of glory; it is attained along the path of righteousness."
- ☐ **Isaiah 46:4**
  "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Still fruitful: Each week, note one way you encouraged or helped.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 92:14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will still bear fruit in old age.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Elderly" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List what you offer. Write skills, stories, and wisdom.
- [ ] Call someone. Reach out to a person who may be lonely.
- [ ] Pray daily. Pray by name for family and friends.
- [ ] Mentor. Offer to share your experience with someone younger.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm old and useless": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Still fruitful
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm old and useless.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You have promised to carry me in old age. Show me how to serve and bear fruit in this season. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.